

Project 03 – APP (Blackboard submission: Dec. 13th / Final review: Dec. 14th)

This project is in teams of 3, but it is individually graded.

The final project explores the process of making and the development of a concept through discovery. In this project you will work with a given context (measurement) and be asked to come up with a concept for what you are measuring and why you are measuring it.

You will be asked to invent an app that measures something. They could measure quantities, qualities, or other metrics of your choice. You must consider how your selected measured matter influences the design of the app.

You will conduct a precedent survey to understand how this chosen measurable matter has been measured and calibrated in the past and in recent design contexts: the goal is to find the gaps in what hasn't been done before and opportunities for invention. You will then conduct your own study to explore the properties of what you are measuring and discover the relationship between your measurable matter and the way you will be measuring it.

You will build, experiment, and test your process throughout the rest of the semester.

At the end of this project, you will develop the concept and narrative about your measurement app, how it fits into a context, how it works, who are the users, and explore proposals for future applications.

Context >> Concept >> Make >> Iterate >> Analysis/Narrative >> Present

App Design: Final Project Deliverables

Your project needs to have following elements:

1. App Name and Description
2. App Screenshots
3. App Video (narrated)
4. App Prototype (link to prototype)
5. Figma File (link or exported)

Your presentation must clearly show your Concept/Narrative/Context/Target market/Features.

For the Blackboard submission, add a section with your progress work.

Here are more details for each of the items on the list:

1 / App Name and Description

App Name: If your app was in an app store, the app's name would play a critical role in how users would discover it. Choose a simple, memorable name that is easy to spell and hints at what your app does. Be distinctive. Avoid names that use generic terms or are too similar to existing app names.

App Description (50 – 100 words): Write up a short text to describe your app. Keep your app's description short and to the point; make sure the first sentence sums up your app. Describe key and unique features. Let potential users know what makes your app unique and why they will love it. Here's an article if you are interested in making the best app description:

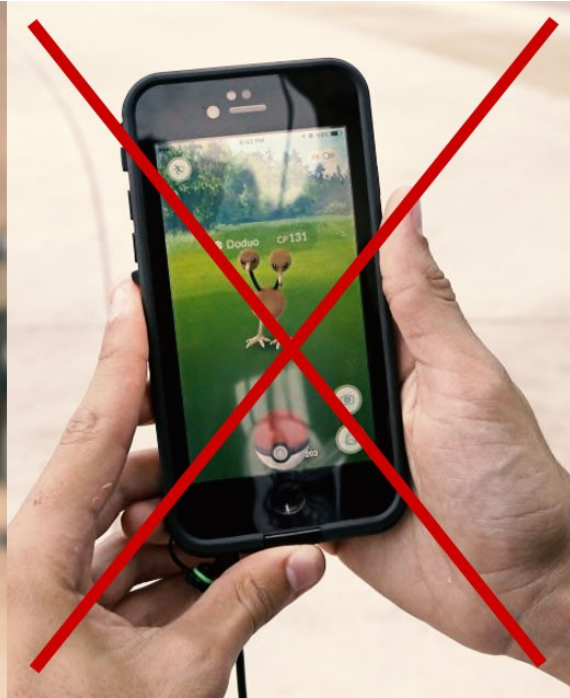
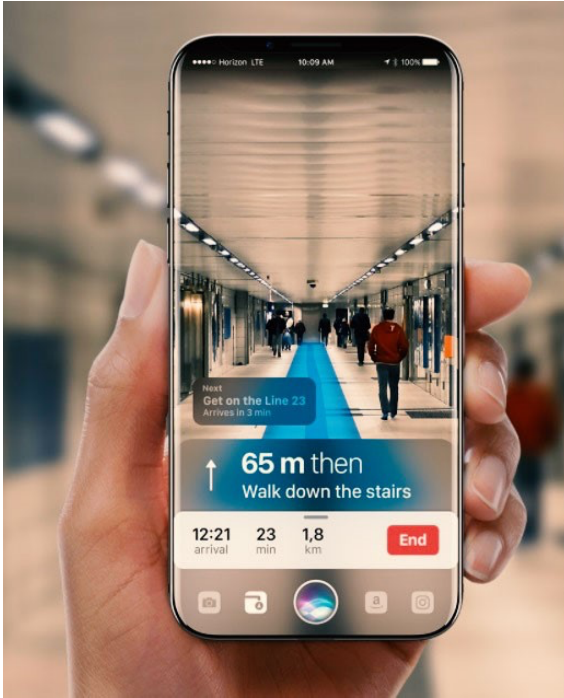
<https://www.entrepreneur.com/article/245067>

2 / Screenshots (1-2 images)

Use screenshots to show off the best and most important features of your app. You should add text to the screenshots to help understand the context better:



Your screenshots must show the entire screen, and they must be perfectly legible. In case you chose to show a scenario of someone using the app, avoid having to apply too much of a perspective distortion to the screens or any other treatment (ie. blurring) that would make the screenshots difficult to read:



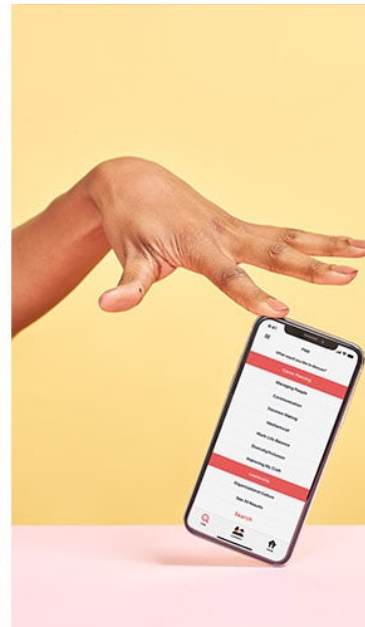
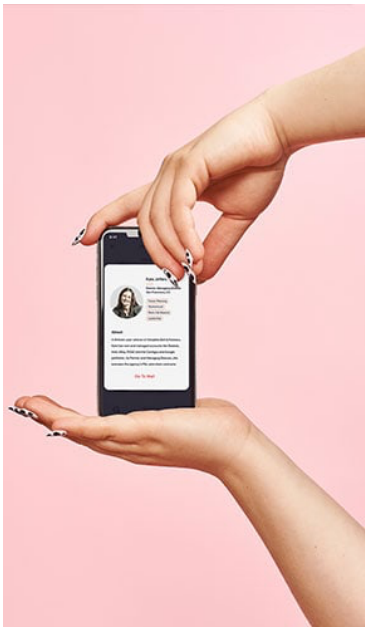
Good:

We can clearly see that the image displayed on screen is the view from camera, as the same (or similar) image is used for both the screen and the background behind the phone.

Bad:

What we see on screen doesn't seem to belong to the same space as we're in. On screen we see a patch of grass while in the background it's all pavement.

You could also use a series of screenshots to create an advertising campaign, for example the following app connects women to provide support:



3 / App Demo Video

The video of your app “in action” is an important part of the project as it will show in detail how your app works. The video should be between 1 – 5min.

There are two different ways to approach creating the video:

- A. Produce a narrated video showing how your app works. The idea is for you to enhance the screen recording by adding a background color or image and adding text to provide more information. Here are some examples:

- <https://vimeo.com/95400260>
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=W-f6F2gxrl4>

Here is another example, this one nicely shows the flow that involves multiple users: <https://vimeo.com/156817690>

Other examples for inspiration, although these are not narrated:

- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZniJfewcbVI>
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EJQjd6CiO9s>
- <https://www.behance.net/gallery/107155039/POW>

Please note that your video **must be narrated**.

- B. You can choose to create a live-action video showing how people use your app in real life (like in a real ad). This can especially work well for the kind of projects where the great part of user experience that your app provides is off-screen, in real life.

An example: <https://vimeo.com/182127205>

Please note that option B is **completely optional**. If you do choose to go for this option, first make a **storyboard** that maps out a list of scenes you'll need and consider how many seconds you want to devote to each scene. Bring your storyboard to class as we need to discuss your storyboard before you start producing it.

If you simply create a screen recording of your app, you will not be complying with the requirements. It must be **narrated** and **enhanced** with text.

Video duration: 1:00 – 5:00 min

Important: Your video must show how your app works. Do not create videos that do not show how your app actually works. Your app must be clearly visible in the video and screenshots.

4 / App Prototype (link to prototype)

Link to a working prototype that can be obtained at "Preview prototype" mode. This prototype should contain all necessary flows, interactions and links between all screens.

5 / Figma File

Link to a file with all necessary permissions, that can be obtained from sharing settings or exported file in .fig format. The Figma file should contain the design of all screens of the app, working prototype and design library with all components and styles.

Final Review

Prepare a compelling and creative presentation of your app with a clear and well-defined audience and set of goals in mind. Explain the app's desired impact. Your presentation must make it perfectly clear what your app does and how it does it. The presentation should last between 10-12 minutes. It is up to you if you want to present your app video at the beginning, middle, or end of your presentation.

Your presentation should make us excited or at least curious about your project. Oral presentation skills and clarity will impact your grade (see grading criteria).

Blackboard Deliverables

The Final Submission is due on Blackboard on Monday, December 13th before 11:59 PM. Only one team member needs to submit the following deliverables:

- Narrated video
- Slide deck from the final review
- Link to a working prototype (it can be obtained at "Preview prototype" mode)
- Link to your Figma file (with all necessary permissions)
- An additional document including:
 - Division of labor (specify which team members worked on the various aspects of the project)
 - App description (50-100 words)
 - 1-2 Screenshots (if not included in the slide deck from the final review)
 - Measurement method
 - Target audience
 - Process (for example, if you went through various iterations, include them)
 - Any other material you consider relevant to your project.

(If any of the materials outlined in this "additional document" section are part of your slide deck, you don't need to include them again).

Workshops

As part of this project, you will have 6 workshops on Figma. Please sign up to Figma and download the desktop app prior to your first workshop: <https://www.figma.com/downloads/>

These are the dates of the workshops:

07.11.2023

14.11.2023

21.11.2023

28.11.2023

30.11.2023

05.12.2023

Check your IE calendar or the MIRO board for the times of the workshops.

Grading Criteria

This assignment is worth 30% of your final grade. Even though this is a group project, it is **individually graded**.

First, I will grade your project according to the grading criteria outlined below. To make the grading of this group project fairer I will then adjust the scores for each individual in the group. For that, I will take into consideration the following:

1. I will review the “division of labor” you submit to Blackboard, where you indicate the allocated tasks and individual contributions to the project.
2. At the end of the project, a group-assessment rubric will be given to each team member asking them to evaluate how each individual contributed to the group as well as the individual’s role as a team player. This gives you an opportunity to provide feedback regarding the effort levels of each group member.

The grading criteria for evaluating your project is outlined below, along with the sub-criteria considered and the points awarded for each category:

Category	Criteria	Scoring
Concept and measurement method	- The project shows significant evidence of originality and inventiveness. The content and ideas are fresh and unique. - The concept and narrative of your measurement app and how it fits into a context is clear. - The project clearly answers the following questions: - What are you measuring? - Why are you measuring it? - How is your app measuring it? (What are the metrics you will use to track and assess what you are measuring?) - Who are you designing for? - Where? - The methodology used for measuring is well designed, coherent, and detailed.	Excellent (9-10 pts) Very good (7-8 pts) Good (5-6 pts) Limited (3-4 pts) Poor (1-2 pts)
Visual Design	- Each interactive element should be clearly recognizable. Or, more technically: each affordance* needs to have a signifier that shows what we can do (ie. tap the button, scroll, zoom, swipe...) - Each screen has a clear visual hierarchy that defines the focus for the screen and what we are expected to do. - The design of all UI elements is consistent on all screens (ie. all buttons should feel the same) and across different UI elements (ie. buttons, checkboxes, switches, etc.) - Choice of visual: Appropriate for the audience and the message being conveyed. Make sure it's clear who your target market is and what their aesthetic taste may be like (hint: always try to improve that taste, never to be complacent with it). What one group of people finds appealing may be off-putting to others, so make your visual design in accordance with who you are designing the app for. - Design: Aesthetically pleasing, limited clutter, good use of color contrast. - Clarity: Appropriate balance of function and design. <i>* Affordance is a feature of an object which presents a prompt on what can be done with this object; they are cues which give a hint how users may interact with something.</i>	Excellent (13-15pts) Very good (10-12 pts) Good (7-9 pts) Limited (4-6 pts) Poor (1-3 pts)
App name and description	- App name is simple, memorable, creative, and fitting to the app's purpose. - App description has a clear intention, revealing the key features, letting potential users know what makes the app unique and why they will love it.	Excellent (5 pts) Very good (4 pts) Good (3 pts) Limited (2 pts) Poor (1pts)

Video	• The video clearly shows how the app works. • Story logic and flow: the narrative/storytelling is compelling, attracting viewers' attention. • Overall visual storytelling of the video: quality of pictures and sound reflects the craft of directing, cinematography, editing and sound design. • Video is smooth, and all frames are in focus. All images enhance the content. • The information included in the video is relevant. • The degree of difficulty (technical and/or conceptual) will also be considered. • Sound/music and titles contribute to the overall message of the video. Music "fits" perfectly with the video. • Text is legible and provides useful information and has the appropriate font/size/location. • Narrative voice is clear. • Video is the indicated length (1 - 5 min).	Excellent (21-25 pts) Very good (16-20 pts) Good (11-15 pts) Limited (6-10 pts) Poor (1-5 pts)
Effort	• Team consistently stayed focused on the task and what needed to be done. Very self-directed, determined, and committed to the project. • Team came to class ready to show their progress and all completed tasks set for that class. • During class-time, the team worked on the in-class exercises in a productive manner. • Team developed the ability to self-critique their own work (ie. students are able to critically evaluate their own design work: what needs improving and why).	Excellent (5 pts) Very good (4 pts) Good (3 pts) Limited (2 pts) Poor (1pts)
Final Review (Presentation)	• Information is presented in a logical sequence. Material included is relevant to the overall message/purpose. • Introduction is attention-getting, lays out the problem well, and establishes a framework for the rest of the presentation. • Speakers maintain good eye contact with the audience and are appropriately animated (e.g., gestures, moving around, etc.). Speakers use a clear, audible voice. Delivery is poised, controlled, and smooth. • Length of presentation is within the assigned time limits. Presentation starts promptly, with no delays. • Visual style of the presentation is appropriate, clear, and high-quality. The text is readable and clear. Graphs/figures are clear and understandable. Appropriate referencing of sources.	Excellent (9-10 pts) Very good (7-8 pts) Good (5-6 pts) Limited (3-4 pts) Poor (1-2 pts)
Technical Competence	Masha will be grading this part. For it, she will review your Figma file and your app prototype, and grade the following:	(0 – 30 pts)

(Figma File and App Prototype)	1. UX interaction and User flow 2. Implementation of Design Principles (ex. User friendly, Hierarchy, Accessibility, Consistency, Aesthetics, etc..) 3. UI Library with all necessary components and styles, and its use across the app. 4. Working Prototype 5. Visual appearance	
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Total points possible: 100

Late policy: Late submission on Blackboard will result in a 20-point reduction. A submission delay of 24h-48h will result in a 40-point reduction. A submission of more than 48h will result in a 50-point reduction. There are no extensions without prior consent of the instructor.

Reach out: If you have any questions, email me, or sign up to the office hours slots on our MIRO board. If you feel overwhelmed with the demands of this course, if you feel like you might miss a deadline, or that you might need to copy work in order to get things done, contact me right away so we can meet on zoom and work out a plan. It is better than plagiarizing or not coming to class.

Mental Health: As a student, you may experience a range of challenges that can interfere with learning, such as strained relationships, increased anxiety, feeling down, difficulty concentrating and/or lack of motivation. These mental health concerns or stressful events may impact your ability to attend class, concentrate, complete work, take an exam, or participate in daily activities.

The student community at IEU has access to their counselling service during the academic year. This service is free and confidential. The team is comprised of guidance counsellors (IEU staff) and clinical psychologists and psychiatrists from SINEWS, a mental health service provider. To schedule an appointment:

- Email: Counseling.IEU@ie.edu (or Mentoring.IEU@ie.edu)
- Phone: (+34) 921 415 312
- 24/7 Mental Health Crisis Line: (+34) 619 270 148 (English/Spanish)

The final presentation will be on Thursday 14th December. Please prepare a 10-12min long presentation. The final submission to Blackboard is due on Wednesday 13th December, before 11:59 PM. **Only 1 team member needs to submit.**